

Civil Services (Main) Qualifying English - Paper B

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 300

INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory except that only one essay topic is to be attempted.
2. Write all answers in English and observe the indicated word limits.
3. Marks in this qualifying paper are not counted for merit ranking.

Q1. Essay [100 marks]

Write about 600 words on any one topic.

1. A right becomes real only when its procedure is usable.
2. Public trust grows through small acts of reliability.
3. Technology should reduce distance, not responsibility.
4. The habit of revision is a sign of strength.

Q2. Comprehension [75 marks]

A public service may be legally available and still remain practically inaccessible. Eligibility rules can be generous while application forms are obscure, offices distant and correction procedures uncertain. In such cases the gap is not between law and complete inaction but between a declared entitlement and a usable route to obtain it. Simplification does not mean removing every check. Verification protects public resources and prevents fraud, but a check should be proportionate to the risk it addresses. Requiring the same document repeatedly from citizens whose information is already held by government shifts administrative failure onto the applicant. Digital services can reduce travel and delay, yet they may create new exclusion when identity matching fails or assistance is unavailable. A sound system therefore provides multiple channels, explains adverse decisions and permits timely appeal. Its success should be measured not merely by applications processed but by whether eligible people receive the service without unreasonable cost, uncertainty or loss of dignity.

1. How can a legally available service remain inaccessible?
2. Why should verification be proportionate?
3. How can digitisation both include and exclude?
4. What procedural safeguards does the author recommend?
5. What measure of success does the passage prefer?

Q3. Precis Writing [75 marks]

Write a precis in about one-third of the passage. Do not give a title.

Expertise is essential in complex administration, but it can create distance between those who design a policy and those who experience it. Specialists know technical constraints and can protect decisions from popular error. Yet professional language may hide assumptions that ordinary users would immediately question. Consultation is therefore not a substitute for expertise; it is a test of whether expertise has understood the problem. Weak consultation merely asks for comments after the main choices are fixed. Better consultation identifies affected groups early, explains alternatives in accessible language and records why major objections were accepted or rejected. Participation cannot mean that every preference becomes policy. Interests conflict, resources are limited and elected institutions must decide. Its value lies in improving evidence, exposing unintended consequences and making reasons visible. Experts remain responsible for technical quality, while decision-makers remain accountable for the values and trade-offs embodied in the final choice.

Q4. Usage and Vocabulary [50 marks]

A. Correct the sentences

1. Each of the reports contain an annexure.

2. The committee comprises of five members.
3. She is senior than me.
4. The news are encouraging.
5. He prevented me to enter.

B. Supply the missing preposition or word

1. conform ____
2. deprive ____
3. prefer X ____
4. refrain ____
5. eligible ____

C. Use the correct verb form

1. When I reached, they ____ (leave).
2. If I ____ (be) you, I would appeal.
3. The files ____ (verify) now.
4. She usually ____ (travel) by bus.
5. They ____ (work) since dawn.

D. Choose the correct word

1. adverse/averse
2. ensure/insure
3. council/counsel
4. imply/infer
5. economic/economical

END OF PAPER